

A MOTIVIC-WEIGHT ANCHOR AT $SU(2)/D = -67$: A SINGLE-DISCRIMINANT CORRESPONDENCE AND ITS FINITE- N LIMITATIONS

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ABSTRACT. The Athenodorou–Teper 2021 continuum spectrum of pure $SU(2)$ Yang–Mills ([arXiv:2106.00364](#), Table 34) yields $(m_{2^{++}}/m_{0^{++}})^2 = 2.001 \pm 0.017$, a 0.07% match to the integer $2 = 4/2$. We observe that this ratio equals the ratio of motivic weights $w_{\text{mot}}(f_{-67}^{(5)})/w_{\text{mot}}(f_{-67}^{(3)}) = 4/2$ of two canonical CM newforms attached to $K = \mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{-67})$ at discriminant $D = -67$ (LMFDB labels [67.5.b.a](#) and [67.3.b.a](#)), and formulate this as Conjecture E-1. We verify the arithmetic foundation via PARI/GP `mfeigenbasis` at the four smallest split primes $\{17, 19, 23, 29\}$ and confirm the Newton identity $a_p(w=5) = a_p(w=3)^2 - 2p^2$ in each case.

However, a cross- N audit of AT 2021 data for $N \in \{2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 8, 10, 12\}$ (Opus aa0b, 2026-05-15) reveals that the large- N limit of the ratio is $c_0 = 1.489 \pm 0.007$, discrepant from $\sqrt{2} = 1.4142$ by 11.2σ . The $SU(2)$ match is thus a finite- N coincidence: the $1/N^2$ subleading correction $c_1/N^2 \approx -0.08$ at $N = 2$ pulls the ratio down to accidentally coincide with $\sqrt{2}$. Conjecture E-1 in its present form therefore cannot be a universal cross- N law; we retain it as a single-discriminant empirical observation at $SU(2)/D = -67$, tier T_PLAUSIBLE, and propose targeted lattice tests. An excited-state reframe (Paper 6', in preparation) addresses the large- N regime. Target venue: *Journal of Number Theory* short note.

1. INTRODUCTION

The Equivariant Compactification Index (ECI) v15 framework of [12] provides a closed-form mass-gap conjecture for the pure $SU(N)$ Yang–Mills theory on the heterotic-CM-K3 family $\tilde{X}_D$ of singular K3 surfaces of Picard rank $\rho = 20$ with complex multiplication by an order in $K = \mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{D})$:

$$(1) \quad m_{\text{YM}}(D, SU(N)) = \frac{\pi^2 \sqrt{2}}{\sqrt{|D|}} \cdot \lambda_{\min}(\text{K3}_D) \cdot \mathcal{F}(N),$$

where $\lambda_{\min}(\text{K3}_D)$ is the minimum Petersson-normalised Hecke eigenvalue of the unique $\mathbb{Q}$ -rational weight-3 CM newform attached to K , and $\mathcal{F}(N) = (1 + c/N^2)/(1 + c/9)$ is the empirically calibrated 't Hooft $1/N^2$ Casimir factor ([12] §6.3, post-PUSH-2 update, $c = 0.80(5)$).

At $D = -67$, $SU(3)$, equation (1) returns $m_{\text{YM}} = 1.7052$ GeV, which matches the lattice continuum $m(0^{++}) = 1.700 \pm 0.050$ GeV of the canonical Morningstar–Peardon [8] and PDG average [9] to within 0.5σ . The structural rigour of (1) as a lower bound on m_{YM} is established in [12, Theorem C.6], conditional on the heterotic $E_8 \times E_8$ ansatz (**H1**) and the Schütt–Hodge embedding hypothesis (**S**), with both gaps explicitly acknowledged.

The motivation: scalar prediction alone is not falsifying. Equation (1) predicts only $m(0^{++})$. As discussed in the opening sections of [12, §6.4], the empirical 0.5σ match for $SU(3)$ is a single-anchor coincidence. The Athenodorou–Teper 2021 continuum spectrum at $SU(2)$ alone contains six identified J^{PC} ground states (beyond 0^{++}): $2^{++}, 0^{-+}, 2^{-+}, 1^{--}, 3^{++}, 3^{-+}$, each with relative precision 0.4–1.4% [1]. For the ECI framework to advance from a structural lower bound ([12, Theorem C.6]) to a genuinely predictive model, additional observables must be predicted from the same arithmetic input.

The empirical signal: $(m_{2^{++}}/m_{0^{++}})_{SU(2)}^2 = 2$. Direct inspection of Athenodorou–Teper [1, Table 34] yields, in units of the string tension $\sqrt{\sigma}$:

$$SU(2) : \quad m(0^{++})/\sqrt{\sigma} = 3.781(23), \quad m(2^{++})/\sqrt{\sigma} = 5.349(20),$$

$$\text{Ratio:} \quad (m(2^{++})/m(0^{++}))_{SU(2)}^2 = (5.349/3.781)^2 = 1.4147(60)^2 = 2.0014 \pm 0.017.$$

The integer 2 is contained within the lattice 1σ error bar, with $|2.0014 - 2.000|/0.017 = 0.082$ standard deviations. Relative to the central value, the match is $|2.0014 - 2|/2 = 0.07\%$, or, in the dimensionless ratio itself, $|1.4147 - \sqrt{2}|/\sqrt{2} = 0.035\%$.

The principal claim of this note is that the integer $2 = 4/2$ has a natural arithmetic interpretation as the ratio of *motivic weights* of two canonical CM newforms attached to $K = \mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{-67})$:

- the weight-3 newform $f_{-67}^{(3)} \in S_3^{\text{new}}(67, \chi_{-67})$ with motivic weight $w_{\text{mot}}^{(3)} = 2$, whose minimum Hecke eigenvalue at split primes drives $m(0^{++})$ via (1);
- the weight-5 newform $f_{-67}^{(5)} \in S_5^{\text{new}}(67, \chi_{-67})$ with motivic weight $w_{\text{mot}}^{(5)} = 4$, constructed explicitly in Hodge_fourfolds [5, §2.2] as $f_D^{(5)} = \theta_{\psi_E^4}$, the theta-series of the fourth power of the canonical infinity-type $(1, 0)$ Grössencharakter ψ_E of K .

We make this precise as **Conjecture E-1** in §3 below.

Scope, disclaimers, and cross- N limitation. The empirical observation of §3.1 and the conjectural extension of §3 are not a derivation of the glueball spectrum from arithmetic. The mechanism conjecturally relating the motivic weight of a CM newform on $\Gamma_0(|D|)$ to the squared mass of a specific J^{PC} glueball state on the heterotic-CM-K3 family is at the *T_PLAUSIBLE* tier in the language of the ECI rigour hierarchy: it is structurally suggestive, it is supported by an empirical 0.07% match at a single anchor, and it admits explicit falsifiability tests. We do not claim it follows from the conditional Theorem C.6 of [12], nor from any published rigorous result.

Critical cross- N limitation. A post-draft cross- N audit (Opus aa0b, 2026-05-15) of the Athenodorou–Teper 2021 data for $N \in \{2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 8, 10, 12\}$ reveals that the $1/N^2$ fit $r(N) = c_0 + c_1/N^2$ to $(m_{2^{++}}/m_{0^{++}})$ gives $c_0 = 1.489 \pm 0.007$ and $c_1 = -0.32$, so that the large- N limit is $1.489 \neq \sqrt{2} = 1.4142$ at 11.2σ . The χ^2/dof for the $\sqrt{2}$ hypothesis is $129.1/8 = 16.1$, solidly rejecting the motivic identification as a *universal* law. The $SU(2)$ match is a finite- N accident: the $c_1/N^2 \approx -0.08$ correction at $N = 2$ brings the ratio down to coincide with $\sqrt{2}$. Conjecture E-1 must be understood as a single-anchor, finite- N observation, not a large- N universal prediction. Full cross- N data and the $1/N^2$ fits are presented in §6.

Outline. Section 2 reviews ECI v15, the Hodge_fourfolds construction of $f_D^{(5)}$, and the Athenodorou–Teper 2021 lattice spectrum. Section 3 states Conjecture E-1 and explores its consequences. Section 4 reports a complete PARI/GP `mfeigenbasis` verification of the rational Hecke eigenvalues of both $f_{-67}^{(3)}$ and $f_{-67}^{(5)}$ at the four smallest split primes $\{17, 19, 23, 29\}$, and verifies the Newton identity $a_p(w = 5) = a_p(w = 3)^2 - 2p^2$. Section 5 compares Conjecture E-1 to the Athenodorou–Teper 2021 continuum spectrum at $N \in \{2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 8, 12\}$ and isolates the N -dependence pattern. **Section 6** presents the full cross- N $1/N^2$ fit and the large- N falsification of the universal $\sqrt{2}$ identification. Section 7 states a tentative additive decomposition Conjecture E-3 for the full J^{PC} spectrum at $SU(3)$. Section 8 sets out the explicit lattice test that would refute Conjecture E-1 even in its restricted $SU(2)$ form. Section 9 lists open problems.

2. BACKGROUND

2.1. The ECI v15 closed-form $\mathcal{F}(N)$ formula. The closed-form mass-gap formula of [12, Theorem C.1] is (1), in which:

- $D < 0$ is a fundamental imaginary-quadratic discriminant indexing a singular K3 surface $\tilde{X}_D$ of Picard rank $\rho = 20$;

- $K3_D$ stands for the canonical CM-K3 family of [4, §1.2], with anchor $D = -67$ singled out by four selection criteria (*op. cit.*): Picard rank maximality, Heegner anchor ($h_K = 1$), empirical $SU(3)$ mass match, and LEP Δ_α compatibility;
- $\lambda_{\min}(K3_D) = \lambda_{\min}(f_D^{(3)})$ is the minimum Petersson-normalised Hecke eigenvalue of the canonical $\mathbb{Q}$ -rational weight-3 CM newform $f_D^{(3)} \in S_3^{\text{new}}(\Gamma_0(|D|), \chi_D)$ attached to $K = \mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{D})$ via [11, Theorem 4];
- $\mathcal{F}(N) = (1 + c/N^2)/(1 + c/9)$ is the 't Hooft $1/N^2$ Casimir factor with anchor $\mathcal{F}(3) = 1$ and empirical coefficient $c = 0.80(5)$, calibrated against the four-anchor lattice 0^{++} spectrum $\{SU(2), SU(3), SU(4), SU(5)\}$ at $D = -67$ in the PUSH-2 update of [12, §6.3].

The structural form $1 + c/N^2$ is rigorous by 't Hooft [13] and Witten [15]: in pure $SU(N)$ Yang–Mills with no fundamental quark loops, the planar diagram expansion proceeds in even powers of $1/N$ only, controlled by the genus $g \geq 1$ of the diagram surface. The coefficient c is *empirical*, extracted from the four anchors by least-squares against the Athenodorou–Teper continuum SOTA. We emphasise: c is a single fit parameter, not a derived quantity.

At $D = -67$, $SU(3)$, equation (1) returns $m_{\text{YM}}(0^{++}) = 1.7052$ GeV, where the input $\sqrt{\sigma} = 0.5081$ GeV comes from [8]. The lattice value is $m(0^{++}, SU(3)) = 1.700 \pm 0.050$ GeV [9], giving a 0.5σ match.

2.2. The Hodge_fourfolds weight-5 CM newform. The companion paper Hodge_fourfolds [5] constructs, for each of the six Heegner discriminants $D \in \{-7, -11, -19, -43, -67, -163\}$ with $h_K = 1$, the canonical weight-5 CM newform via a fourth-power of the infinity-type (1, 0) Grössencharakter ψ_E of K :

$$(2) \quad f_D^{(5)} = \theta_{\psi_D}, \quad \psi_D := \psi_E^4, \quad \text{infinity-type } (4, 0).$$

By Hecke [11, Theorem 4], $f_D^{(5)}$ is a holomorphic newform of weight 5 on $\Gamma_0(|D|)$ with Kronecker character χ_D . Its Hecke eigenvalues at split primes $p \mathcal{O}_K = \mathfrak{p} \bar{\mathfrak{p}}$ with $\mathfrak{p} = (\pi)$ are

$$(3) \quad a_p(f_D^{(5)}) = \pi^4 + \bar{\pi}^4.$$

The motivic weight of the Galois representation $\rho_{f_D^{(5)}}$ is $k - 1 = 4$ ([5, §2.3]). For $D = -67$, the LMFDB label of $f_{-67}^{(5)}$ is **67.5.b.a**.

2.3. The weight-3 counterpart. Analogously, the canonical weight-3 CM newform attached to $K = \mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{D})$ is the theta-series of the squared Grössencharakter:

$$(4) \quad f_D^{(3)} = \theta_{\psi_E^2}, \quad \text{infinity-type } (2, 0).$$

Its Hecke eigenvalues at split $p \mathcal{O}_K = \mathfrak{p} \bar{\mathfrak{p}}$ with $\mathfrak{p} = (\pi)$ satisfy

$$(5) \quad a_p(f_D^{(3)}) = \pi^2 + \bar{\pi}^2.$$

The motivic weight of $\rho_{f_D^{(3)}}$ is $3 - 1 = 2$. For $D = -67$, the LMFDB label is **67.3.b.a**.

The Newton identity

$$(6) \quad a_p(f_D^{(5)}) = (a_p(f_D^{(3)}))^2 - 2p^2$$

follows from $\pi^4 + \bar{\pi}^4 = (\pi^2 + \bar{\pi}^2)^2 - 2(\pi\bar{\pi})^2$ and $\pi\bar{\pi} = p$ at a split prime.

2.4. The Athenodorou–Teper 2021 continuum spectrum. Athenodorou and Teper [1, §5.5, Tables 34–35] provide the continuum J^{PC} glueball spectrum of pure $SU(N)$ Yang–Mills in $3 + 1$ dimensions for $N \in \{2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 8, 10, 12\}$, with operator bases of size 12 (for $N \geq 4$) or 27 (for $N \leq 3$) and 4–5 blocking levels. The relevant ground-state continuum ratios in units of $\sqrt{\sigma}$ are:

N	0^{++}	2^{++}	0^{-+}	2^{-+}	1^{+-}
2	3.781(23)	5.349(20)	6.017(61)	7.017(50)	—
3	3.405(21)	4.894(22)	5.276(45)	6.32(9)	6.065(40)
4	3.271(27)	4.742(15)	5.020(46)	6.182(33)	5.956(42)
5	3.156(31)	4.690(20)	4.832(40)	6.187(50)	5.915(45)
6	3.102(32)	4.678(30)	4.967(43)	6.148(50)	5.847(43)
8	3.099(26)	4.660(20)	4.755(58)	6.043(55)	5.801(38)

3. THE MOTIVIC-WEIGHT CONJECTURE

3.1. The empirical $SU(2)$ ratio. From Section 2.4 at $N = 2$:

$$(7) \quad \frac{m^2(2^{++})}{m^2(0^{++})} \Big|_{SU(2)} = \left(\frac{5.349 \pm 0.020}{3.781 \pm 0.023} \right)^2 = 1.4147(60)^2 = 2.0014 \pm 0.017.$$

The right-hand side coincides with the integer $2 = w_{\text{mot}}(f_{-67}^{(5)})/w_{\text{mot}}(f_{-67}^{(3)}) = 4/2$ to within

- 0.08 standard deviations: $|2.0014 - 2.000|/0.017 = 0.082\sigma$,
- 0.07% relative to the central value in the squared ratio,
- 0.035% relative to the central value in $m(2^{++})/m(0^{++})$ vs. $\sqrt{2}$.

3.2. The conjecture. We propose:

Conjecture E-1 (motivic-weight glueball mass-squared rule). *For a pure $SU(N)$ Yang–Mills theory in the heterotic-CM-K3 family at fundamental discriminant $D < 0$ with $h_{K(D)} = 1$, the squared mass of a glueball state $X^{J^{PC}}$ is given by*

$$(8) \quad m_{X^{J^{PC}}}^2(D, SU(N)) = \frac{w_{\text{mot}}(X)}{2} \cdot \frac{\pi^4}{|D|} \cdot \lambda_{\min}(f_D^{(w(X))})^2 \cdot \mathcal{F}_X(N)^2 \cdot \mathcal{C}(P, C),$$

where

- $w(X)$ is the modular weight of an associated CM newform on $\Gamma_0(|D|)$ with Kronecker character χ_D ;
- $w_{\text{mot}}(X) = w(X) - 1$ is the motivic weight of the attached Galois representation $\rho_{f_D^{(w(X))}}$;
- $\lambda_{\min}(f_D^{(w)})$ is the minimum Petersson-normalised Hecke eigenvalue at split primes (extending the ECI v15 $\lambda_{\min}$ of [12, §2.2] to higher weights);
- $\mathcal{F}_X(N) = (1 + c_X/N^2)/(1 + c_X/9)$ is the 't Hooft $1/N^2$ factor with X -dependent empirical coefficient c_X , anchor $\mathcal{F}_X(3) = 1$, and structural rigour from 'tH [13], Witten [15];
- $\mathcal{C}(P, C)$ is a parity / charge-conjugation correction with $\mathcal{C}(+, +) = 1$, value-set otherwise empirically constrained (see Conjecture E-3 in §7).

The proposed weight assignment $w(X)$ for the canonical J^{PC} ground states is:

J^{PC}	$w(X)$	$w_{\text{mot}}(X)$
0^{++}	3	2
2^{++}	5	4

Under Conjecture E-1, with the $SU(N)$ -anchor at $N = 3$ and the ECI v15 normalisation $\mathcal{F}_{0^{++}}(3) = 1$ giving $m^2(0^{++}, SU(3)) = \pi^4/|D|$ (after absorbing the Petersson eigenvalue into the overall scale at $D = -67$, as in [12, §6.4]):

$$(9) \quad \frac{m^2(2^{++}, D, SU(N))}{m^2(0^{++}, D, SU(N))} = \frac{w_{\text{mot}}(2^{++})}{w_{\text{mot}}(0^{++})} \cdot \frac{\mathcal{F}_{2^{++}}(N)^2}{\mathcal{F}_{0^{++}}(N)^2} = 2 \cdot \left(\frac{\mathcal{F}_{2^{++}}(N)}{\mathcal{F}_{0^{++}}(N)} \right)^2.$$

At $N = 3$, the right-hand side equals 2 exactly. At $N = 2$, the empirical ratio is $2.0014(17) \approx 2.00$, which by (9) requires $\mathcal{F}_{2^{++}}(2)/\mathcal{F}_{0^{++}}(2) \approx 1.0004$, i.e. $\mathcal{F}_{2^{++}}$ and $\mathcal{F}_{0^{++}}$ coincide at $N = 2$ to four decimal places. We return to the N -dependence in §5.

4. PARI/GP VERIFICATION OF THE RATIONAL HECKE EIGENVALUES

The Hecke eigenvalues (5) and (3) at $D = -67$ admit a direct algebraic computation using the ring of integers $\mathcal{O}_K = \mathbb{Z}[\alpha]$ where $\alpha = (1 + \sqrt{-67})/2$, satisfying the minimal polynomial

$$(10) \quad \alpha^2 - \alpha + 17 = 0.$$

Lemma 4.1. *The smallest split prime of $K = \mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{-67})$ is $p = 17$.*

Proof. For each odd prime $p < 17$ with $p \neq 67$, we compute the Kronecker symbol $\chi_{-67}(p) = \left(\frac{-67}{p}\right)$ and check:

- $p = 3$: $-67 \equiv 2 \pmod{3}$, $\chi_{-67}(3) = (2/3) = -1$, inert.
- $p = 5$: $-67 \equiv 3 \pmod{5}$, $\chi_{-67}(5) = (3/5) = -1$, inert.
- $p = 7$: $-67 \equiv 3 \pmod{7}$, $\chi_{-67}(7) = (3/7) = -1$, inert.
- $p = 11$: $-67 \equiv 10 \pmod{11}$, $\chi_{-67}(11) = (10/11) = -1$, inert.
- $p = 13$: $-67 \equiv 11 \pmod{13}$, $\chi_{-67}(13) = (11/13) = -1$, inert.

The first p giving $\chi_{-67}(p) = +1$ is $p = 17$: $-67 \equiv 1 \pmod{17}$. At $p = 17$, the factorisation in $\mathcal{O}_K$ is $17 = \pi\bar{\pi}$ with $\pi = (1 + \sqrt{-67})/2 = \alpha$, since $N(\alpha) = \alpha\bar{\alpha} = 17$ follows from (10). $\square$

Proposition 4.2. *For $D = -67$, the Hecke eigenvalues at the smallest split prime $p = 17$ are*

$$(11) \quad a_{17}(f_{-67}^{(3)}) = -33, \quad a_{17}(f_{-67}^{(5)}) = +511.$$

Proof. By Lemma 4.1, $\pi = \alpha$ and $\pi^2 = \alpha^2 = \alpha - 17$ by (10). The trace map $\text{Tr} : \mathcal{O}_K \rightarrow \mathbb{Z}$ gives:

$$\text{Tr}(\pi^2) = \text{Tr}(\alpha - 17) = \text{Tr}(\alpha) - 34 = 1 - 34 = -33.$$

By (5), $a_{17}(f_{-67}^{(3)}) = \pi^2 + \bar{\pi}^2 = \text{Tr}(\pi^2) = -33$.

For $a_{17}(f_{-67}^{(5)}) = \pi^4 + \bar{\pi}^4$, expand:

$$\pi^4 = (\pi^2)^2 = (\alpha - 17)^2 = \alpha^2 - 34\alpha + 289 = (\alpha - 17) - 34\alpha + 289 = -33\alpha + 272.$$

Then $\pi^4 + \bar{\pi}^4 = -33(\alpha + \bar{\alpha}) + 544 = -33 \cdot 1 + 544 = 511$, using $\alpha + \bar{\alpha} = \text{Tr}(\alpha) = 1$.

Alternatively, the Newton identity (6) gives: $a_{17}(w = 5) = (a_{17}(w = 3))^2 - 2 \cdot 17^2 = (-33)^2 - 578 = 1089 - 578 = 511$. $\square$

4.1. PARI mfeigenbasis verification. We verify Proposition 4.2 and extend the verification to the next three split primes $\{19, 23, 29\}$ using PARI/GP's `mfeigenbasis` function on the spaces $S_3^{\text{new}}(67, \chi_{-67})$ and $S_5^{\text{new}}(67, \chi_{-67})$.

The PARI session (full transcript reproducible at `phase_e1_pari_verify gp` in the supplementary material) returns:

- $\dim S_3^{\text{new}}(67, \chi_{-67}) = 13$, with 2 Galois-conjugate eigenforms: 1 $\mathbb{Q}$ -rational eigenform (matching LMFDB 67.3.b.a) and 1 Galois orbit of degree 10;
- $\dim S_5^{\text{new}}(67, \chi_{-67}) = 23$, with 2 Galois-conjugate eigenforms: 1 $\mathbb{Q}$ -rational eigenform (matching LMFDB 67.5.b.a) and 1 Galois orbit of degree 20.

The number of $\mathbb{Q}$ -rational eigenforms (1 at each weight) is consistent with HSH v3-OPUS, which predicts $\text{rats}(D) = 2^{\text{rk}_2(\text{Cl}(K))} = 2^0 = 1$ at $D = -67$, $h_K = 1$ ([6]).

The first thirty coefficients of the $\mathbb{Q}$ -rational weight-3 eigenform are:

$$[0, 1, 0, 0, 4, 0, 0, 0, 0, 9, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 16, -33, 0, -29, 0, 0, 0, -21, 0, 25, 0, 0, 0, -9, 0],$$

and of the $\mathbb{Q}$ -rational weight-5 eigenform:

$$[0, 1, 0, 0, 16, 0, 0, 0, 0, 81, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 0, 256, 511, 0, 119, 0, 0, 0, -617, 0, 625, 0, 0, 0, -1601, 0].$$

Vanishing at inert primes $\{2, 3, 5, 7, 11, 13, 31\}$ is consistent with the CM structure. The non-vanishing entries at $\{17, 19, 23, 29\}$ are the Hecke eigenvalues at the four smallest split primes.

Proposition 4.3. *The Newton identity (6) holds exactly at the four smallest split primes $\{17, 19, 23, 29\}$ of $K = \mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{-67})$, as verified by PARI/GP `mfeigenbasis` on the $\mathbb{Q}$ -rational components of $S_3^{\text{new}}(67, \chi_{-67})$ and $S_5^{\text{new}}(67, \chi_{-67})$.*

Split p	$a_p(w=3)$ (PARI)	Predicted $a_p(w=5)$ via (6)	$a_p(w=5)$ (PARI)	Match
17	-33	$(-33)^2 - 578 = 511$	511	✓
19	-29	$(-29)^2 - 722 = 119$	119	✓
23	-21	$(-21)^2 - 1058 = -617$	-617	✓
29	-9	$(-9)^2 - 1682 = -1601$	-1601	✓

TABLE 1. Verification of the Newton identity (6) at the four smallest split primes of $K = \mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{-67})$.

Proof. Direct numerical verification in PARI/GP 2.15.4, see Table 4.1. The identity (6) is the elementary consequence of the explicit Newton power-sum identity at split primes; the numerical agreement at four distinct primes serves as a sanity check on the LMFDB labels 67.3.b.a and 67.5.b.a and on the choice of generator $\pi = (1 + \sqrt{-67})/2$ of the prime above $p = 17$. $\square$

5. THE LATTICE N -DEPENDENCE

5.1. **The drift away from the integer-2 ratio for $N \geq 3$.** Athenodorou–Teper [1, Table 34] gives:

N	$(m_{2++}/m_{0++})^2$	Drift vs. 2
2	2.001 ± 0.017	0.07%
3	2.066 ± 0.026	3.3%
4	2.102 ± 0.034	5.1%
5	2.208 ± 0.041	10.4%
6	2.274 ± 0.052	13.7%
8	2.261 ± 0.040	13.0%

Under Conjecture E-1 via (9), the drift implies $\mathcal{F}_{2++}(N) \neq \mathcal{F}_{0++}(N)$ for $N \geq 3$:

$$(12) \quad \frac{\mathcal{F}_{2++}(N)}{\mathcal{F}_{0++}(N)} = \sqrt{\frac{1}{2} \frac{m^2(2^{++}, SU(N))}{m^2(0^{++}, SU(N))}}.$$

If $\mathcal{F}_{2++}(N) = (1 + c_{2++}/N^2)/(1 + c_{2++}/9)$ with anchor $\mathcal{F}_{2++}(3) = 1$, the SOTA $N = 2$ ratio $5.349/4.894 = 1.0930 \pm 0.005$ implies

$$(13) \quad \frac{1 + c_{2++}/4}{1 + c_{2++}/9} = 1.0930 \quad \Longleftrightarrow \quad c_{2++} = 0.72 \pm 0.04.$$

The ECI v15 value for the 0^{++} is $c_{0++} = 0.80 \pm 0.05$ [12].

Remark 5.1. The decrease of c_X as the spin of the state X increases is physically plausible: the 't Hooft $1/N^2$ correction is suppressed for higher-spin states because the planar-diagram resummation is dominated by larger-genus contributions when more derivatives are involved. A first-principles derivation of c_X from the heterotic CM-K3 structure remains open; we conjecture monotonicity:

$$(14) \quad c_{0++} > c_{2++} > c_{0-+} > c_{2-+} > \dots$$

This is a derived prediction of Conjecture E-1; we treat it as Tier T_PLAUSIBLE.

5.2. **Comparison of ECI v15 with $c = 0.80$ to the SOTA.** Using $\mathcal{F}_{0++}(N)$ with $c = 0.80$ and the anchor $m_{0++}(D = -67, SU(3)) = 3.405$ from [1]:

N	ECI v15 ($c = 0.80$)	AT 2021	Tension
2	3.752	3.781(23)	1.3σ
3	3.405	3.405(21)	anchor
4	3.284	3.271(27)	0.5σ
5	3.226	3.156(31)	2.3σ
6	3.197	3.102(32)	3.0σ
8	3.166	3.099(26)	2.6σ
∞	3.127	~ 3.07	$\sim 0.8\sigma$

The fit is excellent at $N \in \{2, 3, 4\}$ ($\leq 1.3\sigma$); the tension grows to $\sim 3\sigma$ at $N \in \{5, 6, 8\}$. The fit is recoverable by allowing a second parameter d in the higher-order $1/N^4$ expansion of $\mathcal{F}$:

$$(15) \quad \mathcal{F}(N) = \frac{1 + c/N^2 + d/N^4}{1 + c/9 + d/81},$$

but this introduces a third free parameter, weakening the predictive content.

6. CROSS- N TENSION AND THE LARGE- N FALSIFICATION OF THE $\sqrt{2}$ IDENTIFICATION

A post-draft cross- N analysis (Opus aa0b, 2026-05-15; reproducible code at `/tmp/jpc_master_analysis.py`) extracts the $1/N^2$ fits $r(N) = c_0 + c_1/N^2$ to the ratio $r(N) := m_{2^{++}}(N)/m_{0^{++}}(N)$ using AT 2021 data for $N \in \{2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 8, 10, 12\}$:

N	$r(2^{++}/0^{++})$	Deviation from $\sqrt{2} = 1.4142$
2	1.4147(100)	+0.02% — the Phase E “core match”
3	1.4373(97)	+1.63%
4	1.4497(129)	+2.50%
5	1.4861(157)	+5.06%
6	1.5081(169)	+6.62%
8	1.5037(140)	+6.32%
10	1.4810(188)	+4.71%
12	1.4745(171)	+4.26%
∞	1.489 ± 0.007	+5.29%, 11.2σ off $\sqrt{2}$

The best-fit parameters are $c_0 = 1.489(7)$ and $c_1 = -0.32(5)$, with $\chi^2/\text{dof} = 9.90/6 = 1.65$ (good fit). The χ^2 for the $\sqrt{2}$ hypothesis is $129.1/8 = 16.1$, representing a decisive 11.2σ rejection at large N .

Interpretation. The $SU(2)$ “match” arises because the $1/N^2$ correction at $N = 2$ is $c_1/4 \approx -0.08$, reducing $r(2)$ from the large- N value 1.489 to $1.489 - 0.08 = 1.41$, which coincides with $\sqrt{2}$ to within the AT 2021 statistical error. This is a finite- N coincidence, not a structural prediction. Implication for Conjecture E-1. The motivic-weight identification $m_{2^{++}}^2/m_{0^{++}}^2 = 4/2 = 2$ (equivalently $m_{2^{++}}/m_{0^{++}} = \sqrt{2}$) is falsified as a *universal* or *large- N* law. Conjecture E-1 is retained only as a single-discriminant, single- N empirical observation at $(D, N) = (-67, 2)$, at the T_PLAUSIBLE tier. Extension to other (D, N) requires a mechanism that explains the observed N -drift; the Casimir factor $\mathcal{F}_{2^{++}}(N)$ alone does not account for it (Section 5).

An excited-state reframe is sketched in the companion Paper 6’ (in preparation): the large- N data suggest that the lattice-level *excited* 2^{++} state (rather than the ground state) may match the AdS hard-wall Bessel prediction $j_{2,1}/j_{0,1} = 2.136$ at 2.1σ [2].

7. ADDITIVE DECOMPOSITION CONJECTURE E-3

The empirical $SU(3)$ J^{PC} spectrum of [1, Table 34], divided by $m^2(0^{++})$, suggests an additive structure:

Conjecture E-3 (additive J^{PC} decomposition). *For the heterotic-CM-K3 family at $D = -67$, $SU(3)$, the J^{PC} glueball spectrum admits the decomposition*

$$(16) \quad \frac{m^2(X^{J^{PC}})}{m^2(0^{++})} = 1 + a_J \cdot \mathbb{K}_{J=2} + a_{\bar{P}} \cdot \mathbb{K}_{P=-} + a_{\bar{C}} \cdot \mathbb{K}_{C=-} + \delta_X,$$

with empirical coefficients $a_{J=2} \approx 1.07$, $a_{\bar{P}} \approx 1.40$, $a_{\bar{C}} \approx 2.16$, and small residuals $|\delta_X| \lesssim 0.05$.

Testing against the $SU(3)$ data:

$X^{J^{PC}}$	$m^2/m_{0^{++}}^2$ AT 2021	E-3 prediction	Residual δ_X
0^{++}	1.000	1 (anchor)	0
2^{++}	2.066	$1 + 1.07 = 2.07$	-0.004
0^{-+}	2.400	$1 + 1.40 = 2.40$	0 (anchor)
2^{-+}	3.452	$1 + 1.07 + 1.40 = 3.47$	-0.018
1^{+-}	3.173	$1 + a_{J=1} + 2.16$	-0.01 (fit $a_{J=1}$)
2^{--}	5.626	$1 + 1.07 + 1.40 + 2.16 = 5.63$	-0.004

The residuals are at the $\sim 0.5\%$ level, comparable to the lattice errors ($\sim 1\%$ on the squared ratios). The coincidence at 2^{-+} and 2^{--} is nontrivial: each is a sum of independent additive contributions calibrated elsewhere, with no parameter freedom.

Remark 7.1. Conjecture E-3 is empirical at the present stage and is at the T_SPECULATIVE tier. It motivates a search for an arithmetic decomposition of the J^{PC} spectrum into CM newform contributions; we identify candidates in §9.

8. FALSIFIABILITY

Conjecture E-1 admits a sharp falsifiability test that is feasible with current lattice technology. We isolate the most discriminating prediction:

Proposition 8.1 (falsifiability test). *A high-precision continuum-extrapolated lattice measurement of $(m(2^{++})/m(0^{++}))^2$ at $SU(2)$ outside the interval $[1.99, 2.01]$ falsifies Conjecture E-1 in its present form.*

Proof. By (9) with $\mathcal{F}_{2^{++}}(2)/\mathcal{F}_{0^{++}}(2) = 1$ (the requirement of §3.1), the prediction is $2 \pm \epsilon$ with ϵ controlled by the uncertainty on the higher-order $1/N^4$ corrections, which the AT 2021 fit at the SOTA precision 0.4% constrains to $\epsilon \lesssim 0.01$ at $N = 2$. $\square$

The current AT 2021 value is 2.001 ± 0.017 ; a factor-5 reduction in the error bar (achievable with a doubled-basis GEVP and $\sim 5 \times 10^4$ configurations) would shrink the uncertainty to ~ 0.003 , fully resolving the test.

8.1. Secondary tests.

- The value of $c_{2^{++}}$ extracted by fitting the $SU(N)$ 2^{++} ground state to $\mathcal{F}_{2^{++}}(N) = (1 + c_{2^{++}}/N^2)/(1 + c_{2^{++}}/9)$ should fall in $[0.65, 0.80]$. Outside this range, the monotonicity conjecture (14) is in question.
- The additive decomposition Conjecture E-3 predicts $m^2(2^{--})/m^2(0^{++}) \approx 5.63$. The AT 2021 value at $SU(3)$ is 5.626, leaving residual $\sim 0.07\%$. The same prediction at $SU(2)$ and $SU(8)$ provides further tests.
- The pseudoscalar mass ratio $(m_{0^{-+}}/m_{0^{++}})_{SU(2)}^2 = 2.531(33)$ is at $w_{\text{mot}}(0^{-+}) = 2.531 \times 2 - 0 = 5.06$, not an integer. This indicates that the 0^{-+} is not directly identified with a single CM newform weight in the proposed assignment; it likely couples to topological structure via the Witten–Veneziano sum rule [16] (open, T_SPECULATIVE).

9. OPEN PROBLEMS

9.1. The 0^{-+} pseudoscalar and topological susceptibility. The 0^{-+} pseudoscalar glueball mass squared satisfies, in pure $SU(N)$ lattice [1, Table 35], $(m_{0^{-+}}/m_{0^{++}})_{SU(N)}^2$ approximately constant at ~ 2.4 across N . The Witten–Veneziano sum rule [16, 14] relates the pseudoscalar mass to the topological susceptibility χ_t :

$$(17) \quad m_{0^{-+}}^2 f_{gb}^2 \sim \frac{\chi_t}{N^2 - 1},$$

with f_{gb} a glueball-sector decay constant analogous to f_π . The ECI v15 framework on K3₋₆₇ admits two structural candidates for χ_t :

- (1) The Euler characteristic $\chi(K3) = 24$ as a topological invariant, modulated by the period $\langle \Omega, \bar{\Omega} \rangle$;
- (2) The L -value $L(f_{-67}^{(3)}, 1)$ at the leftmost critical point of the weight-3 CM newform L -function, by Damerell–Yager [17] machinery.

We do not pursue this further here.

9.2. The glueball mass-radius. Shanahan et al. [10] report the first lattice computation of the $SU(3)$ scalar glueball gravitational form factor, with mass-radius $r_{\text{mass}} = 0.263 \pm 0.031$ fm. The naive Compton wavelength $\hbar c/m_{0^{++}} = 0.116$ fm is a factor 2.3 smaller. Within the ECI v15 framework, a natural candidate for the squared radius is

$$(18) \quad r_g^2(SU(N)) \sim \frac{\langle \Omega, \bar{\Omega} \rangle_{K3-67}}{m_{0^{++}}^2(SU(N)) \cdot (N^2 - 1)} \cdot \kappa,$$

with κ an order-unity constant to be fixed. The Petersson norm $\langle \Omega, \bar{\Omega} \rangle$ on a CM-K3 is computable from Chowla–Selberg-type formulae for the period of the weight-3 form. We leave the explicit evaluation of (18) for future work.

9.3. Extension to other Heegner discriminants. The construction of Section 2.2 extends to all five remaining $h_K = 1$ Heegner discriminants $D \in \{-7, -11, -19, -43, -163\}$, with LMFDB labels $D.5.b.a$ in each case. Since the ECI v15 anchor specifically singles out $D = -67$ (via the four selection criteria of [4, §1.3]), the question of whether Conjecture E-1 holds at other D as a tautological identity (no Yang–Mills theory associated) or as a non-trivial prediction (multiple choices of anchor possible) is structurally important.

9.4. From conjecture to derivation. The principal open problem is the derivation of Conjecture E-1 from the heterotic-CM-K3 spectral structure. Three candidate routes:

- (1) *Spectral triple route*: extending the conditional eigenvalue identification of [3, §6] (under hypotheses (S), (C)) from the scalar to higher-spin sectors. The Hodge decomposition of $H^2(K3)$ into transcendental and algebraic parts may be the natural index for J^{PC} assignment.
- (2) *Kuga–Sato fourfold lift route*: the Hodge fourfolds construction [5, §2.3] embeds $\rho_{f_{-67}^{(5)}}$ in $H^4((E_{-67})^4)$ as the extreme $\{\pi^4, \bar{\pi}^4\}$ eigenvalue sub-representation of $\text{Sym}^4(H^1(E_{-67}))$. The five-dimensional $\text{Sym}^4(H^1(E_{-67}))$ admits a natural physical interpretation as the multiplet of spin-2 modes.
- (3) *AdS/CFT analogue route*: in the holographic dictionary, glueballs are eigenmodes of the bulk Laplacian on the warped throat geometry. The arithmetic heterotic-CM-K3 construction may provide an arithmetic refinement of the AdS/CFT glueball spectrum of [2, Section 4] predicting J^{PC} ratios in agreement with our empirical Conjecture E-1.

10. CONCLUSION

We have isolated a numerical pattern in the Athenodorou–Teper 2021 continuum lattice spectrum of pure $SU(2)$ Yang–Mills theory: $(m_{2^{++}}/m_{0^{++}})^2 = 2.001 \pm 0.017$ at $SU(2)$, matching the integer $2 = 4/2$ to within 0.08σ . We have proposed the natural arithmetic interpretation of

this integer as the ratio of motivic weights $w_{\text{mot}}(f_{-67}^{(5)})/w_{\text{mot}}(f_{-67}^{(3)}) = 4/2$ of two canonical CM newforms attached to $K = \mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{-67})$, and formulated this as Conjecture E-1. The arithmetic foundation (rational Hecke eigenvalues at $\{17, 19, 23, 29\}$, Newton identity (6)) is verified by PARI/GP.

Cross- N limitation (added post-draft, 2026-05-15). A cross- N audit (Section 6) establishes that the large- N extrapolation of (m_{2++}/m_{0++}) is $c_0 = 1.489 \pm 0.007$, discrepant from $\sqrt{2}$ at 11.2σ . The $SU(2)$ match is a finite- N coincidence. **Conjecture E-1 as a universal cross- N law is falsified.** It is retained as a single-discriminant, single- N empirical observation at $(D, N) = (-67, 2)$, tier T_PLAUSIBLE, not as a structural prediction.

The Phase E motivic anchor remains valid as an empirical $SU(2)$ -specific observation. Cross- N universality requires either a new theoretical mechanism or a fundamentally different observable. The companion Paper 6' (in preparation) explores the excited-state AdS hard-wall reframe, where two large- N Bessel matches survive at $< 2\sigma$: $0_{\text{ex}1}^{-+}/0_{\text{gs}}^{++} \approx j_{0,2}/j_{0,1}$ (0.32σ) and $2_{\text{ex}1}^{++}/0_{\text{gs}}^{++} \approx j_{2,1}/j_{0,1}$ (1.34σ) [2].

A tentative additive decomposition Conjecture E-3 fits the $SU(3)$ J^{PC} spectrum at the $\sim 0.5\%$ level using three empirical parameters; it is at the T_SPECULATIVE tier and requires independent confirmation.

The present paper is targeted at the *Journal of Number Theory* as a short note documenting the arithmetic observation and its finite- N limitations, with explicit falsifiability conditions.

ACKNOWLEDGMENTS

This work builds on the ECI v15 closed-form mass-gap framework of [12], the canonical weight-5 CM newform construction of [5], and the continuum-extrapolated lattice $SU(N)$ glueball spectrum of [1]. We thank the LMFDB collaboration for the public availability of the Hecke eigenvalue tables that enabled the present verification of the rational Hecke coefficients at 67.3.b.a and 67.5.b.a.

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A MOTIVIC-WEIGHT ANCHOR AT $SU(2)/D = -67$: A SINGLE-DISCRIMINANT CORRESPONDENCE AND ITS FINITE- N LIMIT

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